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REPORT | NOVEMBER 13, 2019

EUROPE'S UNAUTHORIZED IMMIGRANT POPULATION PEAKS IN 2016,
THEN LEVELS OFF

Appendix B: Unauthorized immigrant population trends with waiting asylum seekers, by country



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Editorial note to readers (March 19, 2025):

This project estimated the number of unauthorized immigrants living in 32 European countries during the mid- to late-2010s. We used what were then the best available data sources from different governments and from the European Union. After our report was published in November 2019, researchers at the University of Oxford's Migration Observatory [identified a problem](#) with the official data from the United Kingdom's Office for National Statistics (ONS) on the number of legal immigrants residing in the UK.

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2.8 million-3.5 million for Europe. [Updated estimates can be found in this table but are not reflected elsewhere in this report.](#)

European unauthorized immigrant population estimates with waiting asylum seekers, 2014-2017

Estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in thousands by country of residence

	2017			2016			2015			2014		
	Low	High	Asylum	Low	High	Asylum	Low	High	Asylum	Low	High	Asylum
Austria	100	200	58	100	200	77	100	200	80	–	<100	30
Belgium	–	<100	19	–	<100	25	–	100	36	–	<100	15
Bulgaria	–	<100	3	–	<100	16	–	<100	10	–	<100	7
Croatia	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Cyprus	–	<100	5	–	<100	3	–	<100	2	–	<100	2
Czech Republic	100	200	<1	100	200	<1	100	200	<1	100	200	<1
Denmark	–	<100	4	–	<100	7	–	<100	15	–	<100	8
Estonia	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
France	300	400	38	300	400	44	200	300	34	200	300	37
Finland	–	<100	9	–	<100	15	–	<100	28	–	<100	2
Germany	1,000	1,200	444	1,100	1,400	602	600	1,200	425	500	600	221
Greece	100	200	48	100	200	40	100	200	26	100	200	32
Hungary	–	<100	<1	–	<100	3	–	<100	37	–	<100	16
Iceland	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Ireland	–	<100	6	–	<100	4	–	<100	5	–	<100	4
Italy	500	700	152	400	600	100	300	600	60	300	500	46
Latvia	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Liechtenstein	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Lithuania	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Luxembourg	–	<100	2	–	<100	2	–	<100	2	–	<100	1
Malta	–	<100	2	–	<100	1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Netherlands	–	<100	7	–	<100	12	–	<100	30	–	<100	9
Norway	–	<100	3	–	<100	7	–	<100	25	–	<100	4
Poland	–	<100	3	100	200	3	–	<100	3	–	<100	3
Portugal	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Romania	–	<100	2	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Slovakia	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Slovenia	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1	–	<100	<1
Spain	100	200	39	100	200	20	100	200	16	100	200	8
Sweden	–	100	51	100	200	83	100	200	157	–	<100	54
Switzerland	100	200	24	100	200	31	–	200	34	–	<100	19
United Kingdom	800	1,200	33	900	1,300	37	800	1,200	34	900	1,200	32
Total EU-EFTA	3,900	4,800	954	4,100	5,300	1,137	3,300	4,900	1,061	3,000	3,700	552

Note: All numbers are rounded; see Methodology for rounding rules. The total number of unauthorized immigrants includes asylum seekers waiting for a decision on their case. "Low" and "High" show the range of estimates for the unauthorized immigrant population. "—" shown for "Low" indicates a population estimate below 100,000. "Asylum" are the number of asylum seekers waiting for a decision on their case, rounded to the nearest 1,000.

Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force survey data.

"Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

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Next: Appendix C: Unauthorized immigrant population trends without waiting asylum seekers, by country

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 How Pew Research Center estimated the number of unauthorized immigrants in Europe

 Summary of findings: (English)

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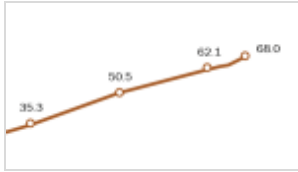
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